DAVID PARK PHD · EVIDENCE-BASED ENTREPRENEURSHIP · FREE WORKSHEET

What Has to Be True? Worksheet

VIDEO 1

Write down what a business depends on, and see which parts you know and which you only believe.

From the video "Why a Good Idea Isn't Enough"

M E R I T — **Market, Edge, Returns, Implementation, Team**

Five questions every business has to answer.

HOW TO USE THIS SHEET

1. Pick a business you know. Your own idea, or a new restaurant that just opened in your neighborhood.
2. For each of the five questions, write what would have to be true for it to work.
3. For each claim, note how good it looks and how you know. Circle the ones you actually know, as opposed to believe.
4. Star the one claim that would most change your mind if it turned out to be false.

1 The business

The business in one line What it is and who it is for

2 What would have to be true

Circle each claim you know, and star the one that would most change your mind.

Question	What would have to be true	How good does it look?	How do you know?
M MARKET — Do enough people want it, badly enough?			
E EDGE — Why would they pick yours over what they do now?			
R RETURNS — Will it make enough money to be worth it?			
I IMPLEMENTATION — Can you build it and deliver it?			
T TEAM — Are you the right people to do it?			

3 Your starred claim

The claim that would most change your mind Copy it from the table

How could you find out, cheaply? Something you could do this week, before you spend real money

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

A new taco place opens on your block. Neighbors want a quick, cheap lunch, and you've seen the line out the door at noon all week, so you circle Market. The owner ran a food truck for six years, so you circle Team too. Whether people will keep choosing it over the pizza place next door once the opening buzz fades is the one you only believe, and it would change your mind most, so it gets the star. The idea itself, a restaurant, is the least interesting thing on the page.

THE TRAP

Confidence feels the same from the inside whether you know something or only believe it, so write down how you know, not how sure you feel.

WHY THIS WORKS

MERIT borrows from research-tested frameworks, but it hasn't been validated as a predictive model. Use it to decide what to check, not to predict who will succeed.

Next video: Where Do Good Opportunities Come From?

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